Ribollita means "reboiled" in Italian, and that is more or less what this soup is—reboiled Zuppa di verdure (see left). It is wonderful, heart-warming comfort food.

ribollita

SERVES 4–6 **PREP** 10 MINS **COOK** 40 MINS **FREEZE** NOT SUITABLE

1 quantity day-old Zuppa di verdure, made up to the point just before the cavolo nero is added
6 cavolo nero or curly kale leaves, or the outer leaves of a Savoy cabbage, tough stalks removed and the leaves coarsely chopped
6 slices good-quality stale bread
1 garlic clove, halved
2–3 tbsp extra virgin olive oil, plus extra to serve
½–1 red onion, very finely sliced
4 tbsp freshly grated Parmesan (optional)

1 Preheat the oven to 375˚F (190˚C). Bring the soup to a boil in a large pan, stir in the cavolo nero, and simmer for 10 minutes or until tender. Meanwhile, rub the stale bread with garlic.

2 Oil a large gratin dish or similar ovenproof dish with olive oil, then spoon about a quarter of the soup into the dish, spreading it over the base. Now, lay half the slices of bread over the soup, then spoon over half the remaining soup. Repeat these two layers one more time. Lay the red onion over the top, then scatter with the Parmesan, if using. Drizzle over a little olive oil, then bake for 30 minutes. Serve sizzling hot, with extra olive oil out on the table for those that want it.